A 9th Grade Navigator for Every School

> **James's collateral:** Built on James Arndt's "A 9th Grade Navigator (Dashboard) for Every School" (Oct 22, 2026). His headline, framing, and most of the first two sections are kept nearly verbatim. **Conversation:** Jonah (10/26): case-making goes up front, "we're having to sell ourselves more than some mega vendor," and it may be repeated inside the agreement's "what CHSS will do" section. Emily (10/26): lead with the case before the agreement.

Syncing your Student Information System (SIS) with CHSS Navigator gives your ninth grade team timely, accurate data through clear visualizations and a dashboard that updates automatically. Your team can analyze, discuss, and intervene in minutes, without running reports, downloading files, and entering formulas. Most districts don't have a ninth grade dashboard like this, or the time and budget to build one. CHSS builds and maintains it for you.

The cost of doing it by hand

> **James's collateral:** Verbatim from James's draft, including the three-step routine and the 20-to-30-minute figure. His "no emails, no manual pulls, no file transfers" is reworded: SFTP is a file transfer, so the honest claim is that nothing is manual once the automated feed runs. **Conversation:** James (10/23): "we waste 20 minutes in every coaching session running the Synergy report, exporting, opening, entering a bunch of Excel formulas." Only 20 of 178 partner schools had submitted Q1 data as of 10/23. **James's collateral:** The Kid Talk figure is from James's 10/23 email: "Our own data shows us that when teams do a Kid Talk with fidelity they are 70%+ more likely to hit their on-track goal." Internal CHSS data; James to confirm it may be cited externally and how it was measured. **District lens:** A superintendent reading an earlier draft saw a credible value proposition and no evidence; one defensible result is what moves "fine" to "we want this."

Without an integration, almost every coaching session starts the same way:

1. The ninth grade lead runs a report from the SIS.
2. The report is exported to Excel.
3. The lead and coach add formulas to flag which students are failing one or two courses.

That routine eats 20 to 30 minutes of a 60-minute session. Half the hour goes to clerical work instead of kids, and the data is often a full grading period old by the time anyone acts on it.

District staff carry a burden too. Each quarter, CHSS asks a district data specialist to pull a large download and upload it to a secure location. That takes time from your most technical people, and the data is months old by the time it's used. Once your automated feed is running, none of that is manual: no emails, no one running reports for CHSS, no one handling files by hand.

This matters because the protocol depends on it. In CHSS partner data, running the Kid Talk protocol with fidelity is associated with a more than 70 percent higher likelihood of hitting the school's on-track goal, and a Kid Talk only works with current data in front of the team. [Method and comparison group to be footnoted once validated.]

What SIS integration gives your team

James's collateral: First five bullets are James's. **Conversation:** Last two bullets added from the 10/19 and 10/23 calls: Tara and Jonah on longitudinal tracking (on-track through CTE, dual credit, graduation) and on end-of-year data arriving in October today, which makes it "really hard to evaluate our staff, evaluate our impact, plan for the next school year."

Student data flows securely from your SIS into CHSS Navigator, where CHSS builds the ninth grade dashboards your team uses. Teams stop building the data and start using it.

- **Time back for kids.** The 20 to 30 minutes once spent preparing data goes back to talking about students.
- **Current data.** Weekly updates once your feed is live: Friday's data for Tuesday's conversation, not last quarter's.
- **Accurate data.** No manual exports or formulas means no copy errors or broken spreadsheets.
- **Faster action.** Teams spot students failing one or two courses and plan support in the same meeting.
- **Visible progress.** Teams can see whether each intervention is working and adjust before the next grading period.
- **A view past ninth grade.** As your cohort moves on, Navigator keeps following it: on-track persistence in 10th grade, CTE course sequences, dual credit, graduation. You see whether the ninth grade work held, and so does your board.
- **End-of-year answers in June, not October.** Automated feeds mean your on-track results are ready when you plan the next year, not after it has started.

What it gives your district

Conversation: The "support you to do something" reframe from the 10/19 call. Jonah: "instead of being seen as 'we're asking you to pretty please do something,' we're actually offering support." Luke: the first question to any district is whether its SIS data lands in a warehouse it owns every night; most who do "are doing the fun stuff." **Luke's experience:** Setting up SchooLinks and other nightly feeds at AFUHSD: once automated, "I don't think about it at all anymore"; a failure notice arrives if the receiving server is down. **AFUHSD precedent:** The executed-copy promise comes from the ASU-Helios thread (Mar 2026), where neither the assistant superintendent, the deputy superintendent, finance, nor the data team could find the district's own signed DSA a few years on. **James's MOU draft:** Section Seven: "Year 0 and Year 1 services are fully subsidized; the amount due from District under this Agreement is $0." The strongest fact in the package, previously absent from the case. **District lens:** A superintendent's worry about an earlier draft: committing staff to "a technically demanding project that the case-making describes as nearly effortless." The staff-effort paragraph and "support until acceptance" answer that directly. "You own your data" was read as boilerplate; it is now a path, not a promise. **Conversation:** Jonah (10/26) on the start date: January "gives us the four or five months of let's get this set up before students start." Year 0 is readiness; live data begins with Year 1 in August 2027.

Most districts run reports by hand because nobody has had the time to set up the alternative. The integration work we do together changes that:

- **$0 due to CHSS.** The accelerator, the dashboard, and the integration work are fully subsidized for Year 0 and Year 1. The amount due from your district under the agreement is $0. What it asks of your staff is stated honestly below.
- **We set it up with you, and stay until it works.** CHSS technical staff meet with your data team, map your SIS exports to the Navigator format, and set up the feed. We stay with it until

the feed passes acceptance, and we come back when your SIS, grading scale, or term structure changes. Most districts need two to four working sessions over a few weeks; your data person runs the export, we handle the mapping and the monitoring.

- **A path to owning your data.** If your district doesn't already keep a nightly copy of its SIS data in a place you control, the feed we build together is a first step, and we'll point you at the routes other districts have taken. Once you have it, every future partner, dashboard, and analysis gets easier, not just ours.
- **Nothing to remember.** Once the feed runs, no one on your staff runs a report for CHSS again. If a transfer fails, our system notices and we follow up.
- **Clean records.** You get an executed copy of every agreement, indexed, and a reminder before anything expires.

What we ask of your staff, honestly. A technical contact and a privacy contact named in the first two weeks. One onboarding call with both. The hours above to stand up the feed, more if your district needs the scheduled-upload route for a while. Nothing from your teachers beyond the ninth grade team work the accelerator already asks for. Data for your ninth grade cohort starts flowing in August 2027; the months before that are for getting the feed and the agreement in place.

Built to protect student privacy

> **James's collateral:** Opening sentence and "your student data remains your district's property" are James's. **Drafting choice:** Discipline removed from "only the data needed." James's draft and Emily's architecture both list it; Tara (10/19) said behavior data is rarely received and isn't needed for on-track; Luke (10/26) called discipline "the most tightly held thing." It stays available as an optional element in the agreement. **Drafting choice:** "Used for one purpose" now carries a second sentence disclosing de-identified evaluation, so the longitudinal work is never a surprise. James's original ("and nothing else") silently excluded it. **Lewis County:** A Missouri partner district's technology coordinator has already asked its consortium to obtain the NDPA with CHSS, so the NDPA commitment is stated here up front. **Conversation:** James (10/26): "we are going to have to sign their data agreement. There's no negotiation there." That is the record behind "will also sign the NDPA." The Exhibit E general offer has no record yet and is not promised here (Decisions, O12). **District lens:** "Do not label an incomplete list 'only the data needed.'" The list now matches Exhibit D-1's Required elements exactly and names the screeners. **Luke's decision:** See Decisions, M9, M18, and M19. **District lens:** A California district technology and privacy lead (10/27 call) reads every partner agreement for four things "with no gray area": auto-renewals, what happens when data is compromised, destruction at the end of the contract, and selling or advertising to third parties. The four are now each a bullet on this page.

SIS integration is governed by a data sharing agreement with your district and designed to meet FERPA and your state's student privacy requirements. CHSS provides its own privacy and security appendix and will also sign the National Data Privacy Agreement (NDPA) in your state's version if your district prefers it. Your student data remains your district's property, and your district decides who can see it.

- **Only the data needed.** CHSS receives student ID, name, grade level and enrollment dates, course enrollments, course marks and credits by grading period, GPA, and attendance. Nothing

else is required. Responses to the short belonging and skills screeners your team administers, after you approve the questions, are held under the same terms.

- **Used for one purpose.** Identifiable student information supports ninth grade success work in your schools and nothing else. CHSS keeps only de-identified and aggregate results to evaluate and improve the program.
- **Deleted when you say so.** When the partnership ends, or whenever you ask, identifiable data is destroyed and we certify it.
- **No automatic renewal.** The data partnership ends with the agreement. Continuing it takes a new signature, not silence.

Who sees what

> **James's collateral:** Table structure and the school-team row are James's. His draft says CHSS coaches and staff see "aggregate data only"; that row changes here and must change in his one-pager, because a coach watching a student-level screen is seeing identifiable records. **FERPA:** "Disclosure" under 34 C.F.R. § 99.3 includes permitting access by any means, oral and visual included. The school official exception authorizes it when its conditions are met; a login is not what makes it a disclosure. **Conversation:** Jonah (10/26) leaned toward the "less intrusive approach" with the team lead screen-sharing; James wanted to ask for access and fall back. Option B keeps Jonah's approach and describes it accurately. **Luke's experience:** AFUHSD's Teach For America agreement (2025–26) accepted the partner's coach seeing student-level data on the basis that the coach is the only partner viewer and is acknowledged as a FERPA school official. **Luke's decision:** Option B is "in-session view," not "aggregate only." See Decisions, M1.

Student names live in Navigator for one reason: so the educators responsible for a student know who needs support and can act. Role-based permissions decide who can see them.

Who	What they see	Why
Your school team (individual logins)	Student-level records: names, course performance, attendance	To identify students, build intervention plans, and monitor progress kid by kid
CHSS coaches	**Option B (default):** no login of their own. They see student-level data only in coaching sessions, alongside your team lead on your team lead's screen, under the same agreement, training, and confidentiality as your staff. Outside sessions they work from aggregate views: on-track rate, course failures, attendance by group. **Option A (district may elect):** their own login to the schools they coach, with every access logged.	To coach your team and measure impact
CHSS program and research staff	De-identified and aggregate data only	To evaluate and improve the program across the network
CHSS technical staff	Minimum-necessary, logged access to administer the system and investigate incidents; never for program or research use	To keep the platform running and secure

Who	What they see	Why
who run the platform		

Records are matched using a consistent unique student identifier, so Navigator stays accurate as students change classes, schedules, and schools.